The Home Savings Safe introduced in 1921 was one of the most important innovations introduced by the Central Bank. Under this scheme, each depositor was given a small safe in which savings could be accumulated before being credited to a savings account at 4 percent per annum. The depositor and the bank, each had a key, and the safe could only be opened after it was brought to the bank. The words on the safe left no doubt as to its purpose: 'Thrift pays dividends.'[4] The depositor could also transfer sums over ₹100 to a fixed deposit for twelve months at a higher rate of interest. The bank was also the first to introduce HSS passbooks and introduce the system of withdrawals by cheques in savings accounts.

The advertisement in the papers under Sorabji's name summed up succinctly the object of the scheme: 'A banker can render no higher service to his constituents and to the public than by teaching them thrift for laying by small savings. The value of a rupee is never realized through earning it. Its value is appreciated through a systematic method of saving a certain part of it—no matter how small that bit is. To promote this object, specially amongst individual members of families and to enable them to meet unforeseen expense and household contingencies, we offer our "Home Savings Safe" Account Scheme to open Savings Bank Accounts with us.'[5] The purpose was to inculcate the savings habit so as to build up a climate favourable to the larger interests of banking. Sir B.N. Mitra, the Chairman of the ICBEC remarked: 'Not content with attracting deposits from the wealthier people, your bank is also doing a special service to the community by encouraging the habit of thrift among the masses of India, and I am sure that no one will dispute your claim to the title of the "People's Own Bank", in the purest sense of the term.'[6]

The Safe Deposit Vault inaugurated in 1926 by the Governor, Sir Leslie Wilson, was another first for Indian banking. The Chairman, Sir Phiroze Sethna, conducted a survey of safe deposit vaults in London and elsewhere. He discovered that deposit vaults were more popular on the Continent than in England and the experience the French had gained in this regard was outstanding. The vaults were imported from Messrs Fichet of France whose vaults were world famous. However, in keeping with its reputation for swadeshi, every single safe in the Central Bank since its inception had been supplied by Godrej whose safes were recognized as being as good as foreign ones.[7] But since it was felt that Godrej and other Indian